to them.[55] This provoked a reaction from the villagers and led to violence between Rohingya villagers and police, which ended when the military used live rounds to disperse the crowds.[56] Journalists and NGOs have been denied access to Maungdaw,[57] and the UN has only been allowed state-supervised access.[58]

The threat of violence continues to be pervasive in Rakhine,[59] and outbursts have continued to occur throughout 2013–15. There have also been attacks on non-Rohingya Muslims living elsewhere in Myanmar.[60] In March 2013, there were attacks led by Buddhist monks in Meiktila near Mandalay, where over 12,000 people were displaced. In advance of the violence, online Facebook postings described the local Muslim population as preparing

> a Jihad. They are gathering in mosques in Mandalay under the guise of Ramadan but in reality they are recruiting and preparing for Jihad against us. The government of Myanmar must deal with these Islamic extremists and raid all suspicious mosques and homes. All Burmans must be ready and not falls into these Muslims' traps.[61]

What is striking is how closely this resembles the material circulated around Rakhine before the October 2012 riots.[62]

Meanwhile, the Myanmar regime remains convinced that the Rohingyas are deliberately, and successfully, manipulating international opinion, and has tried to cut off communication links between the Rohingyas and the outside world. Fortunately, due to social media and sympathetic external connections this has only been partially successful. In addition, there has also been a concerted pattern of excluding aid agencies from the country, the most notable example being when Medécins Sans Frontières (MSF) was ordered out of Rakhine and prevented from supporting the Rohingya community after events in 2014.[63] In effect, MSF have been banned for continuing to provide a minimal level of support and, specifically:

> the charity has been targeted for its stance on a massacre said to have taken place in Maungdaw township, a restricted area close to the Bangladesh border, where UN and human rights groups claim at least 40 Rohingya Muslims including children were killed by ethnic Rakhine Buddhists and Burmese security forces in January.[64]

The regime has come to see any critical mention of the conditions endured by the Rohingyas as an attack on the state, and will eagerly revoke access to NGOs if they speak out. This has also had a chilling effect on the way the situation in the area is being reported and is steadily eroding the